

SS3 CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS STUDIES LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: CIVIC RESPONSIBILITIES

1.1 MEANING OF CIVIC RESPONSIBILITIES

Civic Responsibilities refer to the set of duties, obligations, and actions that a citizen (a legally recognized member of a state) is expected to perform for the well-being and effective functioning of their community, state, or nation.

These responsibilities are the citizen's part of the "**social contract**"—an unspoken agreement where the state provides rights, protection, and services, and in return, the citizen provides duties, allegiance, and support.

1.2 EXAMPLES OF CIVIC RESPONSIBILITIES

1. **Obedience to Laws:** Adhering to the established laws of the land (e.g., traffic laws, criminal laws, sanitation laws) to maintain order and peace.
2. **Payment of Taxes:** Honestly and promptly paying all required taxes (e.g., income tax, VAT, property tax). This is the primary way the government funds public services.
3. **Voting:** Participating in the democratic process by registering to vote and casting a ballot during elections to choose responsible leaders.
4. **Community Service:** Voluntarily offering time and skills to help improve the community (e.g., participating in environmental sanitation, volunteering at an orphanage, joining a neighbourhood watch).
5. **Respect for National Symbols:** Showing respect for the flag, the national anthem, the pledge, and the currency.
6. **Assisting Law Enforcement:** Reporting crimes, serving as a witness when called, and cooperating with security agencies to maintain law and order.
7. **Defending the Country:** Being willing to protect the nation from internal or external threats. (e.g., the National Youth Service Corps - NYSC - is a form of this).

1.3 IMPORTANCE OF CIVIC RESPONSIBILITIES IN NATION BUILDING

The nation is not just the government; it is the collective body of its citizens. Without active citizen participation, a nation cannot be built.

1. **Maintenance of Law and Order:** When citizens obey laws, it creates a peaceful and stable society where development can occur.
2. **Provision of Public Services:** Tax revenue is the *lifeblood* of the nation. It is what pays for roads, hospitals, schools, electricity, and the salaries of public workers (police, teachers, doctors).
3. **Ensuring Good Governance:** Voting is the tool citizens use to hold bad leaders accountable and elect good ones. Apathy (not voting) allows corruption and incompetence to thrive.
4. **Fostering National Unity:** Community service and respect for national symbols build a sense of shared identity and patriotism, rising above ethnic or religious divides.
5. **Economic Development:** When citizens are responsible (e.g., working honestly, paying taxes), it creates a stable environment that attracts foreign and local investment.

1.4 BIBLICAL TEACHINGS ON CIVIC DUTIES (ROMANS 13:1–7)

The Bible is clear that Christians are citizens of both heaven *and* the nation they live in. They have a "dual citizenship" with responsibilities to both.

Key Passage: Romans 13:1–7 (NIV)

"Let everyone be subject to the governing authorities, for there is no authority except that which God has established. The authorities that exist have been established by God... (4) For the one in authority is God's servant for your good... (6) This is also why you pay taxes, for the authorities are God's servants, who give their full time to governing. (7) Give to everyone what you owe them: If you owe taxes, pay taxes; if revenue, then revenue; if respect, then respect; if honor, then honor."

Analysis of the Passage:

- **Paul's Context:** Paul was writing to Christians living in Rome, the heart of an often-brutal pagan empire. His instruction was radical.
- **The Principle:** God is a God of order, not chaos. He has established the *concept* of government ("governing authorities") to maintain order, punish wrongdoers, and protect the innocent.
- **The Christian's Duty:**
 1. **Be Subject (v. 1):** A Christian should obey the laws of the land. The only exception is if the law directly commands the Christian to sin against God (Acts 5:29 - "We must obey God rather than human beings!").
 2. **Pay Taxes (v. 6-7):** Paul is explicit. Paying taxes is a Christian duty. The government is "God's servant," and taxes are the "payment" for the service of maintaining public order.
- **Jesus' Teaching:** This affirms Jesus' own words in **Matthew 22:21**, when asked about taxes: "Render therefore unto Caesar the things which are Caesar's; and unto God the things which are God's."

Contemporary Relevance in Nigeria:

- The Christian citizen is commanded to be the *best* citizen.
- This means refusing to participate in corruption, obeying traffic laws even when no one is watching, paying taxes honestly (not looking for ways to cheat), and praying for the nation's leaders (1 Timothy 2:1-2).

EVALUATION (WEEK 1)

1. What is a "civic responsibility"?
2. List five (5) examples of civic responsibilities.
3. Explain two reasons why the payment of taxes is crucial for nation-building.
4. According to Romans 13, why should a Christian be subject to governing authorities?
5. What was Jesus' teaching on paying taxes (Matthew 22:21)?

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 1)

1. Read Romans 13:1-7. Write a 300-word essay on the topic: "Is a Christian justified in disobeying the government if the government itself is corrupt and fails to provide services?"
2. List five specific "civic responsibilities" within your *school* community (e.g., proper waste disposal, not engaging in exam malpractice).



WEEK 2: HIV/AIDS I

2.1 MEANING OF HIV AND AIDS

- **HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus):** This is the **virus** that causes the disease. HIV attacks the body's immune system, specifically the **CD4 cells (or T-cells)**, which are the "generals" of the immune system. Over time, the virus destroys so many of these cells that the body can no longer fight off infections.
- **AIDS (Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome):** This is the **syndrome**, or the late stage of the HIV infection.
 - **Acquired:** It is not hereditary; you acquire (get) it after birth.
 - **Immuno-Deficiency:** The immune system is deficient (weak).
 - **Syndrome:** A collection of symptoms and diseases.
 - A person does not "die of AIDS." They die of "**opportunistic infections**" (like tuberculosis, pneumonia, or certain cancers) that a healthy immune system would normally fight off. AIDS is diagnosed when the CD4 cell count drops below a critical level (200 cells/mm³).

2.2 CAUSES AND MODES OF TRANSMISSION

HIV is the *cause*. It is transmitted when infected body fluids from a person with HIV enter the bloodstream of an uninfected person.

The ONLY fluids that can transmit HIV are:

- Blood
- Semen
- Pre-seminal fluid
- Vaginal fluids
- Rectal fluids
- Breast milk

The FOUR main modes of transmission are:

1. **Unprotected Sexual Intercourse:** This is the *most common* mode of transmission, through vaginal, anal, or (less commonly) oral sex with an infected person.
2. **Infected Needles/Sharps:** Sharing needles or syringes used for injecting drugs. Also, in the past, through unsterilized medical/tattooing/barbing equipment.
3. **Mother-to-Child Transmission (MTCT):** An infected mother can pass the virus to her baby *during* pregnancy, *during* childbirth, or *through* breastfeeding. (This is now highly preventable with ARVs).
4. **Infected Blood Transfusion/Products:** Receiving blood from an infected donor. (This is now very rare in Nigeria, as all blood is screened).

2.3 BIBLICAL PERSPECTIVES ON SEXUAL PURITY

The Bible, in both the Old and New Testaments, commands that sexual expression be reserved exclusively for a lifelong, monogamous marriage between a man and a woman. All sexual activity outside this bond is considered sin.

- **1 Corinthians 6:18-20 (NIV):** "Flee from sexual immorality. All other sins a person commits are outside the body, but whoever sins sexually, sins against their own body. Do you not know that your bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit... Therefore honor God with your bodies."
 - **Analysis:** Paul argues that a Christian's body is not their own; it is the "temple" of God. Sexual sin is uniquely destructive because it defiles this temple.
- **Hebrews 13:4 (NIV):** "Marriage should be honored by all, and the marriage bed kept pure, for God will judge the adulterer and all the sexually immoral."
 - **Analysis:** This verse sets a high standard for marriage and warns that God will hold accountable those who engage in sex outside of it (adultery - if married; fornication - if unmarried).
- **Other Passages:** Genesis 2:24 (the "one flesh" union), 1 Thessalonians 4:3-5 (avoiding passion and lust).

2.4 CONSEQUENCES OF IMMORAL LIVING

"Immoral living" (in this context, sexual activity outside of marriage) has profound consequences that are spiritual, emotional, and physical.

1. **Spiritual Consequence:** It is a sin against God, which damages one's fellowship with Him and requires repentance.
2. **Emotional Consequences:** Can lead to guilt, shame, broken trust, damaged relationships, and a loss of self-respect.
3. **Physical Consequences:**
 - **STIs/STDs:** Risk of incurable (HIV, Herpes) and curable (Syphilis, Gonorrhea) infections.
 - **Unwanted Pregnancy:** Leads to complex social issues (e.g., single parenthood, abortion, interruption of education).
4. **Social Consequences:** Can lead to broken homes, "baby-mama/daddy" culture, loss of reputation, and stigma.

2.5 PREVENTIVE MEASURES

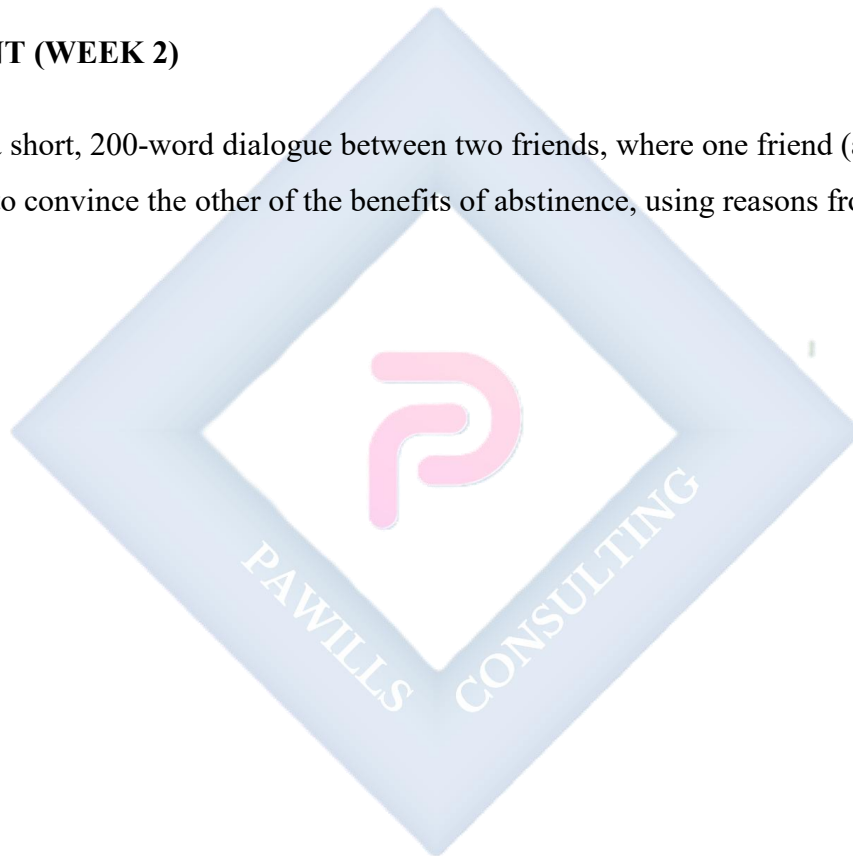
1. **Abstinence:** This is the 100% effective, biblical, and Christian standard of prevention. It means refraining from all sexual intercourse until marriage.
2. **Be Faithful:** For those who are married, remaining 100% faithful to one uninfected partner.
3. **Avoid Sharing Needles/Sharps:** Never share injecting equipment. Ensure all barbing, piercing, or tattooing tools are new or properly sterilized.
4. **Screening of Blood:** All blood for transfusion *must* be screened for HIV and other pathogens.
5. **Prevention of MTCT (PMTCT):** An infected pregnant woman *can* have an HIV-negative baby by taking **Antiretroviral (ARV) drugs** during pregnancy, having a C-section (if advised), and not breastfeeding (using formula instead).
6. **Public Health Measures (The "C" of ABC):** For those who will not abstain or be faithful, public health bodies recommend **Condoms**. While condoms *reduce* the risk, they are *not* 100% effective (they can break or be used improperly). This is *not* the biblical method, but it is a public health strategy.

EVALUATION (WEEK 2)

1. What is the full meaning of HIV? What is the full meaning of AIDS?
2. What specific type of cell in the immune system does HIV attack?
3. List the four (4) main modes of HIV transmission.
4. According to 1 Corinthians 6, why is sexual sin so serious?
5. What is the "ABC" model of prevention? Which part is the 100% effective Christian standard?

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 2)

1. Write a short, 200-word dialogue between two friends, where one friend (a Christian) is trying to convince the other of the benefits of abstinence, using reasons from this lesson.



WEEK 3: HIV/AIDS II

3.1 MYTHS AND MISCONCEPTIONS ABOUT HIV/AIDS

Fear and ignorance have created many myths about HIV/AIDS, which has led to harmful stigma and discrimination. It is crucial to separate fact from fallacy.

Myth / Misconception	Fact / Reality
1. "You can get HIV from mosquito bites."	FALSE. HIV does not survive in a mosquito and cannot be transmitted this way.
2. "You can get HIV from casual contact (hugging, shaking hands, sharing toilets)."	FALSE. HIV is <i>not</i> transmitted through saliva, sweat, or tears. You cannot get it from sharing food, toilets, or cups.
3. "HIV/AIDS is a curse from God or witchcraft."	FALSE. HIV is a virus. It is a medical condition, not a spiritual curse.
4. "You can tell if someone has HIV just by looking at them."	FALSE. A person with HIV can look perfectly healthy for <i>many years</i> (the "asymptomatic" stage). Only a blood test can know.
5. "HIV/AIDS is an immediate death sentence."	FALSE. This was true in the 1980s, but today, with Antiretroviral (ARV) drugs , HIV is a <i>chronic, manageable condition</i> (like diabetes). A person on ARVs can live a long, healthy, and productive life.
6. "If both partners have HIV, they don't need to use protection."	FALSE. They can still infect each other with <i>different strains</i> of the virus ("superinfection"), and they can still transmit other STIs.
7. "An infected mother will <i>always</i> pass HIV to her baby."	FALSE. With proper PMTCT (see Week 2), the risk of transmission can be reduced from ~30% to <i>less than 1%</i> .

3.2 EFFECTS OF HIV/AIDS

The effects are devastating and ripple out from the individual to the whole nation.

- **On Individuals:**

- **Physical:** Weakened immune system, opportunistic infections, side effects from ARV drugs.
- **Psychological:** Fear, depression, anxiety about the future, denial.
- **Social: Stigma and Discrimination**—being rejected by family, friends, and community; losing one's job or housing.

- **On Families:**

- **Economic:** Cost of drugs and hospital visits can drain family savings. The infected person (often a breadwinner) may lose their job, pushing the family into poverty.
- **Social:** The "Orphan Crisis"—millions of children left orphaned by AIDS.

- **On Society / Nation:**

- **Loss of Workforce:** It kills the most productive age group (18-45), leading to a "brain drain" and skill shortage in all sectors.
- **Economic Strain:** The government must spend a huge part of its budget on healthcare (ARVs, hospitals) instead of on development (roads, schools).
- **Lowered Life Expectancy:** Widespread infection can lower the average life expectancy of the entire nation.

3.3 ROLE OF CHRISTIANS IN SHOWING CARE AND COMPASSION

The Christian response to HIV/AIDS must be driven by the example of Jesus Christ, not by fear or judgment.

1. **Replace Judgment with Compassion:** Jesus *never* shied away from the "unclean." He actively sought out and touched lepers (Mark 1:40-42) and ate with "sinners" (Mark 2:15-17). The Christian's role is to be the "hands and feet of Christ" to those who are suffering.
2. **Fight Stigma and Discrimination:** Christians must be at the *forefront* of fighting myths. We must be the first to hug, shake hands with, and share a meal with someone who is HIV-positive, demonstrating the truth that it is not spread by casual contact.
3. **Provide Care and Support:** The early church was known for its practical care (Acts 4:34). Churches can:

- Provide financial and nutritional support (food banks) for affected families.
 - Run support groups for those living with the virus.
 - Care for orphans and widows (James 1:27).
4. **Educate and Prevent:** The church is the perfect place to teach the biblical standard of abstinence and faithfulness (Week 2), which is the *best* prevention.
 5. **The Good Samaritan Model (Luke 10):** The priest and the Levite (the "religious" people) "passed by on the other side." The Samaritan (the "outcast") showed compassion and *paid the cost* of caring for the wounded man. Christians must be the Good Samaritan.

3.4 BIBLICAL SUPPORT FOR HEALTHY LIVING

The Bible teaches that our bodies are a gift from God, and we have a responsibility of "stewardship" over them.

- **1 Corinthians 6:19-20:** "...your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit... Therefore honor God with your bodies."
- **1 Corinthians 10:31:** "So whether you eat or drink or whatever you do, do it all for the glory of God."
- **Meaning:** This applies to all of health. We should honor God by avoiding things that harm our bodies (sexual immorality, drug abuse, gluttony) and by actively caring for our health (good nutrition, exercise, rest).

EVALUATION (WEEK 3)

1. List three common myths about HIV/AIDS and the scientific fact that debunks them.
2. What is the difference between HIV being a "death sentence" and a "chronic, manageable condition"? What made the difference?
3. List two effects of HIV/AIDS on the *individual* and two on the *nation*.
4. Using the example of Jesus and the lepers, what should the Christian's *first* response be to someone with HIV?
5. What does 1 Corinthians 6:19-20 teach about our bodies?

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 3)

1. Imagine a close friend tells you they are HIV-positive and are afraid of being rejected.
2. Write a letter (300 words) to this friend, using the principles from this lesson, to show your compassion, support, and to give them hope.



WEEK 4: INDEPENDENCE AND SELF-ACTUALIZATION

4.1 MEANING OF INDEPENDENCE

Independence (or Self-Reliance) is the state of being able to depend on oneself—managing one's own affairs, making one's own decisions, and providing for one's own needs without being under the control of others.

- **Financial Independence:** Earning your own income.
- **Emotional Independence:** Not relying on others for your happiness or validation.
- **Intellectual Independence:** Thinking for yourself, forming your own opinions.

4.2 SELF-RELIANCE AND PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY

Self-reliance is the *ability* to be independent. It is built on a foundation of **personal responsibility**—the understanding that *you* are the primary person accountable for your own life, actions, and well-being. A self-reliant person does not blame others for their failures; they learn from them and take action.

4.3 WAYS OF ACHIEVING SELF-ACTUALIZATION

Self-Actualization (a term from psychologist Abraham Maslow) is the *highest* level of human development. It is the full realization of one's talents and potential. It is becoming the "best version" of yourself.

To achieve this, one must first meet their basic needs (food, safety, love, esteem). The steps to self-actualization include:

1. **Discover Your Talents:** Identify your God-given gifts and abilities.
2. **Acquire Knowledge and Skills:** Get an education or vocational training. A person without skills cannot be self-reliant.
3. **Hard Work and Diligence:** Apply yourself to your work (see Week 6).
4. **Discipline and Goal-Setting:** Set clear, realistic goals and have the discipline to pursue them, even when it is difficult.

5. **Integrity and Good Character:** Build a reputation for being honest, reliable, and trustworthy.

4.4 BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF SELF-RELIANT INDIVIDUALS

The Bible is filled with examples of people who used their skills and integrity to become self-reliant and achieve God's purpose.

1. **Joseph (Genesis 37-41):**

- **Challenge:** Betrayed by his brothers, sold as a slave, and falsely imprisoned in Egypt.
- **Self-Reliance:** In every situation, he used his *skills* (administration in Potiphar's house, interpretation in prison) with *integrity*. He did not wait for rescue; he worked with excellence.
- **Result:** His diligence and God-given skill made him indispensable. He rose from prisoner to Prime Minister ("self-actualization") and saved the nation.

2. **Apostle Paul (Acts 18:1-4):**

- **Challenge:** As a missionary, he needed funding.
- **Self-Reliance:** Paul was a **tentmaker** by trade. Instead of demanding payment from the churches, he often worked with his own hands to support his ministry.
- **Result:** This gave him independence and integrity; he was not a "burden" to the new converts and could not be accused of preaching for money.

3. **The "Virtuous Woman" (Proverbs 31:10-31):**

- **Description:** This woman is the *opposite* of a dependent person.
- **Self-Reliance:** "She considereth a field, and buyeth it: with the fruit of her hands she planteth a vineyard." (v. 16). She is a businesswoman, a manufacturer (she makes and sells linen), a manager of her household, and is strong and wise.
- **Result:** Her family and community respect and praise her.

4.5 IMPORTANCE OF DEPENDING ON GOD (THE CHRISTIAN BALANCE)

Christian self-reliance is a **paradox**. It is *not* a "Western" or "Atheistic" individualism that says, "I need no one." Christian self-reliance says, "I must use 100% of the skills God gave me, while depending 100% on Him for the outcome."

- **Parable of the Talents (Matthew 25:14-30):** The master gave talents to the servants "according to their several ability." He expected them to *work* and *use* those talents. The servant who "buried his talent" (was idle and irresponsible) was condemned. God *expects* us to be responsible and self-reliant with the gifts He gave us.
- **Proverbs 3:5-6:** "Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths."
- **The Balance:** We work hard (Proverbs), but we trust God (Proverbs). We use our skills (Joseph), but we know the ultimate promotion comes from God (Psalm 75:6-7).

EVALUATION (WEEK 4)

1. Define "Self-Reliance" and "Self-Actualization."
2. What is the "Parable of the Talents," and what does it teach about self-reliance?
3. Using Joseph as an example, explain how integrity and skill lead to self-actualization.
4. Explain the "Christian paradox" of being self-reliant while also depending on God.

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 4)

1. Read Proverbs 31:10-31 (The Virtuous Woman).
2. List five (5) actions this woman takes that demonstrate she is "self-reliant" and a good entrepreneur.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

This week is for the Midterm Examination, covering all topics from Weeks 1-4.



WEEK 6: DIGNITY OF LABOUR

6.1 MEANING OF LABOUR AND DIGNITY

- **Labour (Work):** Any physical or mental effort exerted by humans to produce goods or services.
- **Dignity:** The inherent, in-built worth and honour that all human beings possess, simply because they are created in the image of God.
- **Dignity of Labour:** This is the principle that **all honest work is honourable**, regardless of its perceived status. The work of a street sweeper, a farmer, or a cleaner has just as much *dignity* as the work of a doctor, a lawyer, or a bank CEO.
 - Dignity is in the *person* and the *honesty* of the work, not in the *salary* or *title*.

6.2 BIBLICAL VIEW ON WORK

The Bible presents work as a fundamental, good, and God-ordained part of human existence.

1. **Work is part of God's Original Design (Genesis 2:15):**
 - "And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the Garden of Eden to **dress it and to keep it.**"
 - **Analysis:** This was *before* the Fall (Sin). God gave Adam a *job* (to be a gardener/steward) in paradise. This means work is **not a curse**. It is a core part of the human purpose. The *curse* (Genesis 3:17-19) was not work itself, but the "thorns and thistles," "sweat," and *toil* that sin introduced.
2. **God Himself is a Worker:**
 - Genesis 1 shows God "working" for six days to create the universe.
 - Jesus said in John 5:17, "My Father is always at his work to this very day, and I too am working."
3. **Work is Commanded and Idleness is Condemned:**
 - **Proverbs 14:23:** "All hard work brings a profit, but mere talk leads only to poverty."
 - **2 Thessalonians 3:10:** "For even when we were with you, we gave you this rule: 'The one who is unwilling to work shall not eat.'" Paul strongly rebuked idleness.

4. Work is a means of Provision and Generosity:

- **Ephesians 4:28:** "Anyone who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must **work**, doing something useful with their own hands, that they may have something to **share with those in need.**" (Work is the antidote to theft and the engine for charity).

6.3 IMPORTANCE OF DIGNITY IN LABOUR

1. **Personal:** Gives the individual a sense of self-worth, purpose, and independence.
2. **Social:** It builds a society based on merit and contribution, not just status. It respects all citizens.
3. **Economic:** It encourages people to take pride in their work (e.g., a cleaner who works diligently, a mechanic who does an honest job), which leads to higher quality services and national productivity.

6.4 CONSEQUENCES OF IDLENESS (NOT WORKING)

The Bible views idleness (sloth, laziness) as a sin and a vice with severe consequences.

- **Poverty:** (Proverbs 6:10-11) "A little sleep, a little slumber... so shall thy poverty come..."
- **Dependence (Parasitism):** An idle person becomes a burden on their family and community (2 Thess. 3:10).
- **Crime:** Idleness is the "devil's workshop." People with no honest work are more susceptible to temptation and crime (e.g., theft, 419, betting).
- **Gossip and Meddling:** (1 Timothy 5:13) Paul warns that idle people become "busybodies, saying things they ought not to."

6.5 RELEVANCE OF HONEST WORK IN CONTEMPORARY SOCIETY

In a society (like contemporary Nigeria) that often struggles with a "get-rich-quick" mentality, "yahoo-yahoo" (internet fraud), and a "shortcut" culture, the principle of Dignity of Labour is a radical counter-message.

- It teaches that there is more honour in the **honest N50,000/month salary** of a plumber or teacher than in the **stolen N5,000,000** of a fraudster or corrupt official.
- It validates the hard work of farmers, artisans, and small traders as the true backbone of the economy.
- **Proverbs 22:29:** "Seest thou a man **diligent** (skilled, hardworking) in his business? he shall stand before kings; he shall not stand before mean men." This promises that excellence in *any* honest labour (no matter how "small") brings respect and success.

EVALUATION (WEEK 6)

1. Define "Dignity of Labour."
2. What does Genesis 2:15 teach us about the origin of work?
3. What was Paul's strong command to the Thessalonians regarding idleness?
4. List three consequences of idleness.
5. How is the principle of "Dignity of Labour" relevant to Nigeria's "get-rich-quick" culture?

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 6)

1. Identify a job in your community that is often seen as "lowly" or "undignified" (e.g., waste collector, market sweeper, bus conductor).
2. Write a one-page essay explaining (a) why that job has dignity and (b) how that job is *essential* to the functioning of your community.

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

This week is for the midterm break.



WEEK 8: CHRISTIAN ATTITUDE TO CORRUPTION

8.1 MEANING OF CORRUPTION

Corruption is the dishonest or fraudulent conduct by those in power, typically involving the **abuse of entrusted power for private gain**. It is the decay of integrity.

8.2 FORMS OF CORRUPTION

1. **Bribery:** Offering, giving, or receiving something of value (money, gifts, "tips") to *influence* a decision or action.
 - *Example:* Giving a police officer money to avoid a fine; a contractor giving a "kickback" to a politician to win a contract.
2. **Fraud:** Deceitful or dishonest acts to gain an advantage or money.
 - *Example:* Exam malpractice; "419" scams; "ghost workers" on a government payroll.
3. **Embezzlement:** The *theft* or misappropriation of public funds entrusted to one's care.
 - *Example:* A government official diverting money meant for a new road into their personal bank account.
4. **Nepotism / Favouritism:** Giving jobs, contracts, or opportunities to family members ("nepotism") or friends ("favouritism") instead of to the most qualified person.
5. **Extortion:** Using one's position or threats to *force* someone to pay money.
 - *Example:* An official refusing to sign a document *until* a bribe is paid.
6. **Dishonesty:** Lying, cheating in business, using false weights and measures.

8.3 EFFECTS OF CORRUPTION

Corruption is a cancer that destroys a nation from the inside out.

- **On Individuals:** Creates cynicism, mistrust, and anger. It robs citizens of their rights and dignity.
- **On Society:**

1. **Increases Poverty and Inequality:** Money meant for the poor (e.g., for schools, hospitals, water) is stolen by the rich, widening the gap.
 2. **Breakdown of Public Services:** Roads are not built, hospitals have no drugs, schools collapse, and the power grid fails because the money was "eaten."
 3. **Erosion of the Rule of Law:** Justice becomes for sale. People lose faith in the police and courts, leading to instability.
- **On the Economy:** It is the *number one* killer of economic development.
 1. Drives away foreign investors, who fear risk and extortion.
 2. Leads to shoddy infrastructure (as contractors cut corners after paying bribes).

8.4 BIBLICAL CONDEMNATION OF CORRUPTION

The Bible, from beginning to end, condemns corruption, which it sees as a perversion of justice and an offense against God.

- **Exodus 23:8:** "And thou shalt take no gift (bribe): for the gift blindeth the wise, and perverteth the words of the righteous."
 - **Analysis:** A bribe makes a leader or judge "blind" to the truth and "perverts" (twists) justice.
- **Amos 5:12:** (The prophet Amos confronts the rich). "For I know your manifold transgressions... they afflict the just, they take a bribe, and they turn aside the poor in the gate from their right."
 - **Analysis:** God condemns corruption because its primary victim is the *poor* and *powerless*. It is a sin against social justice.
- **Micah 6:11:** "Shall I count them pure with the wicked balances, and with the bag of deceitful weights?"
 - **Analysis:** Condemns business fraud and dishonesty.
- **Proverbs 17:23:** "A wicked man taketh a gift out of the bosom to pervert the ways of judgment." (Condemns bribery).
- **New Testament:** John the Baptist told the tax collectors and soldiers to "collect no more than you are authorized" and "do not extort money" (Luke 3:12-14).

8.5 CHRISTIAN RESPONSE TO CORRUPTION

A Christian cannot be "neutral" about corruption.

1. **Personal Integrity (Be the Salt):** The first response is *personal*. A Christian must refuse to *give* or *take* bribes (Matthew 5:13, "You are the salt of the earth"). They must be the "light" that exposes the darkness.
2. **Be Diligent and Honest:** Be the honest worker, the fair business owner (like Joseph or Daniel).
3. **Speak Out (Prophetic Voice):** The Church and individual Christians have a *duty* to speak out against injustice and corruption, just as the prophets (Amos, Micah) did.
4. **Pray for Leaders:** (1 Timothy 2:1-2) Pray for leaders to be just and righteous.
5. **Obey the Law:** A Christian's obedience to the law (Romans 13) is a testimony *against* a lawless society.

EVALUATION (WEEK 8)

1. Define corruption and list its four main forms.
2. What is the difference between "embezzlement" and "nepotism"?
3. List three major effects of corruption on society.
4. What does Exodus 23:8 say a bribe does to a "wise" person?
5. What are the two *first* and *most important* responses a Christian should have to corruption?

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 8)

1. You are a public official. A contractor offers you a large sum of money to approve his substandard work.
2. Write a 300-word response (a "memo" or "letter") to him, explaining from a Christian perspective why you cannot accept his offer, citing both biblical principles and the negative impact on the nation.

WEEK 9: FORGIVENESS

9.1 MEANING OF FORGIVENESS

Forgiveness is a conscious, deliberate decision to release feelings of resentment, bitterness, or vengeance toward a person (or group) who has harmed you, regardless of whether they "deserve" it.

What Forgiveness is NOT:

- It is **NOT** forgetting. The memory of the hurt may remain.
- It is **NOT** excusing or condoning the sin. The sin was still wrong.
- It is **NOT** removing the consequences. (e.g., You can forgive a thief, but he must still go to jail).
- It is **NOT** always reconciliation. Forgiveness is an *internal* act; reconciliation is a *two-way* process of rebuilding trust. You can forgive someone (in your heart) without trusting them again.

9.2 BIBLICAL TEACHINGS ON FORGIVENESS

Forgiveness is a *central, non-negotiable* command in Christianity.

1. The Motive: God's Forgiveness of Us

- **Colossians 3:13:** "Bear with each other and forgive one another if any of you has a grievance against someone. **Forgive as the Lord forgave you.**"
- **Analysis:** The *reason* we must forgive others is because Christ has forgiven us of our infinitely greater debt of sin against God.
- **Parable (Matthew 18:23-35):** Jesus tells the parable of the "Unforgiving Servant," who is forgiven a massive debt (10,000 talents) by his king, but then goes out and chokes his fellow servant over a tiny debt. The king is furious and throws the first servant in jail. The moral is that it is hypocritical for a Christian, who has been forgiven by God, to refuse to forgive others.

2. The Measure: Unlimited Forgiveness

- **Matthew 18:21-22:** "Then Peter came to Jesus and asked, 'Lord, how many times shall I forgive my brother... Up to seven times?' Jesus answered, 'I tell you, not seven times, but **seventy times seven.**'"
- **Analysis:** This number (490) is a Jewish symbol for *infinity*. Jesus is teaching that forgiveness should be limitless, just as God's forgiveness is.

3. The Condition: Forgiveness is Tied to Our Own Salvation

- **Matthew 6:14-15:** (Part of the Lord's Prayer): "For if ye forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you: But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses."
- **Analysis:** This is a terrifying warning. An unforgiving heart is a sign that a person has not truly understood or *received* God's forgiveness for themselves.

4. The Model: The Prodigal Son

- **Luke 15:11-32:** The father in the story *is* God. When the rebellious son returns, the father:
 - Shows **compassion** ("he ran to his son").
 - Shows **total forgiveness** (he doesn't lecture him; he kisses him).
 - Shows **total restoration** (he gives him the robe, ring, and sandals).
 - This is the model of God's "lavish" forgiveness.

9.3 IMPORTANCE OF FORGIVENESS IN CHRISTIAN LIVING

- It is a **direct command** from Christ.
- It is **essential for fellowship** with God (Matt 6:15).
- It is the **evidence** that we have been "born again" and have the spirit of Christ.

9.4 BENEFITS OF FORGIVENESS

- **To the Forgiver (Individual):**
 - **Spiritual:** Restores fellowship with God.
 - **Psychological/Emotional:** It brings *freedom*. It breaks the chain of bitterness, anger, and resentment that "eats" the unforgiving person.

- **Physical:** Unforgiveness is a major source of stress, which can lead to high blood pressure, ulcers, and other health problems.
- **To the Community (Society):**
 - **Reconciliation:** It is the *only* way to heal deep community wounds (e.g., ethnic clashes, political violence, or even post-civil war trauma).
 - **Peace:** It breaks the "cycle of revenge" (e.g., "they killed one of us, we must kill one of them").

EVALUATION (WEEK 9)

1. Define "Forgiveness." What are two things that forgiveness is *not*?
2. What is the main *motive* for a Christian to forgive, according to Colossians 3:13?
3. What did Jesus mean by "seventy times seven" (Matthew 18)?
4. In the Parable of the Prodigal Son, how does the father model God's forgiveness?
5. List one benefit of forgiveness for the *individual* and one for the *community*.

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 9)

1. Read the Parable of the Unforgiving Servant (Matthew 18:23-35).
2. Write a 300-word "modern-day" version of this parable (e.g., using Naira and modern debts) and explain its moral.

WEEK 10: PERSEVERANCE, WEALTH AND POVERTY

10.1 PERSEVERANCE

- **Meaning:** Perseverance is the quality of **steadfast endurance**. It is the ability to continue in a course of action, a belief, or a purpose *despite* difficulty, failure, or opposition. It is "not giving up."
- **Biblical Examples:**
 1. **Job:** The ultimate example of perseverance. He lost his wealth, his children, and his health, but he "did not sin by charging God with wrongdoing" (Job 1:22). He endured his suffering with his faith (mostly) intact and was restored in the end.
 2. **Joseph:** Endured 13 years of injustice as a slave and a prisoner, holding on to his integrity and his faith in God, before rising to power.
 3. **Apostle Paul:** He was shipwrecked, beaten, imprisoned, stoned, and starved. Yet he wrote in 2 Timothy 4:7, "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith."

10.2 WEALTH

- **Meaning:** The state of being rich; having an abundance of money, property, or valuable possessions.
- **Acquisition:** Wealth can be acquired through hard work (Proverbs), wise investment, inheritance, or (sinfully) through dishonesty and oppression.
- **Biblical Guidelines on Wealth:**
 - **Wealth is NOT a Sin:** The Bible is *not* against wealth. Abraham, David, and Job were all extremely wealthy men of God.
 - **The Love of Money IS a Sin:** This is the key distinction. **1 Timothy 6:6-10:** "For the **love of money** is the root of all evil: which while some coveted after, they have erred from the faith, and pierced themselves through with many sorrows."
 - **Wealth is a Snare (Danger):** Jesus warned that riches can make it difficult for a person to enter heaven (Matthew 19:23-24, Parable of the Rich Fool), because people *trust* in their wealth instead of in God.

- **Wealth is a Tool (Stewardship):** The Bible teaches that wealth is a *tool* given by God, and the wealthy are *stewards* who have a responsibility to be "rich in good deeds... willing to share" (1 Timothy 6:17-19).

10.3 POVERTY

- **Meaning:** The state of being extremely poor; lacking the resources for a minimum standard of living.
- **Causes:**
 - **Personal:** Laziness, idleness (Proverbs 6:10-11 - "so shall thy poverty come").
 - **External:** Natural disasters (drought, floods).
 - **Systemic (Injustice):** Oppression, corruption, low wages, and a society that "turns aside the poor from their right" (Amos 5:12).
- **Biblical Response to Poverty:** The Bible is *not* neutral about poverty; it commands a radical response.
 1. **Charity (Generosity):**
 - **Proverbs 19:17:** "He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the LORD; and that which he hath given will he pay him again." (God sees giving to the poor as a "loan" to Himself).
 - The law of "gleaning" (Leviticus 19:9) commanded farmers to *not* harvest the edges of their fields, but to leave it for the poor.
 2. **Communal Care:**
 - **Acts 4:32-35:** The early church practiced a radical form of sharing: "...and they distributed to each as any had need. There was not a needy person among them."
 - **Analysis:** They had a *collective responsibility* to ensure that poverty was *eliminated* within their community.
 3. **Justice:**
 - The Bible's response is *not just* charity, but **justice**. The prophets (like Amos) did not just tell people to "give to the poor"; they *condemned* the

rich and powerful for *creating* the poverty through their "deceitful weights" and "bribes."

EVALUATION (WEEK 10)

1. Define perseverance and name two biblical examples.
2. What is the *key difference* between "having wealth" (which is not a sin) and the "love of money" (which is)?
3. According to 1 Timothy 6, what is the "root of all evil"?
4. List two *causes* of poverty mentioned in the Bible.
5. What was the "Biblical Response to Poverty" demonstrated by the early church in Acts 4?

ASSIGNMENT (WEEK 10)

1. Read the Parable of the Rich Fool (Luke 12:13-21).
2. Write a 300-word analysis of the parable. What was the rich man's "sin"? (Hint: it was not "being rich").

WEEK 11: REVISION

- **Comprehensive Review:** This week is dedicated to a full review of all topics from the First Term.
- **Key Themes:**
 1. **The Christian as a Citizen (Weeks 1, 8):**
 - Duties: Paying taxes, obeying laws, voting (Romans 13).
 - Attitude to Corruption: Personal integrity, speaking out (Amos 5, Exodus 23).
 2. **Social and Ethical Issues (Weeks 2, 3, 10):**
 - **HIV/AIDS:** Facts vs. Myths. The Christian response *must* be compassion (like Jesus to lepers), not judgment.
 - **Wealth & Poverty:** The *love* of money is the sin, not money itself. The Christian response to poverty is both *charity* (Proverbs 19) and *justice* (Amos).
 3. **Personal Character (Weeks 4, 6, 9, 10):**
 - **Self-Reliance:** Using God-given talents (Parable of Talents, Joseph).
 - **Dignity of Labour:** All honest work is noble; idleness is a sin (Gen 2:15, 2 Thess 3:10).
 - **Forgiveness:** It is unlimited (70x7) and essential for our own salvation (Matt 6:14-15).
 - **Perseverance:** Enduring suffering with faith (Job, Paul).
- **Final Exam Strategy:** Be prepared to *apply* biblical principles to modern-day scenarios. (e.g., "A friend is engaging in exam malpractice. How would you advise them using the principles of 'Dignity of Labour' and 'Christian Attitude to Corruption'?").